

Combat Weapons chart (see p. 286) and the Ranged Combat Weapons chart (see p. 287). Damage rolls are always made at a difficulty of 6, and each success on this roll causes one health level of the appropriate type of damage. Three successes on a damage roll for a punch does three health levels of bashing damage, while two success rolls on a damage roll with a broadsword does two health levels of lethal damage. Damage rolls cannot be botched; the only options are success or failure.

Soaking Damage

Characters can sometimes shrug off an attack. To do this, they soak the damage. Without wearing armor, changelings, like ordinary mortals, can only soak bashing damage and lethal damage that is chimerical. Wearing armor allows the wearer to also soak aggravated and non-chimerical lethal damage, using the armor's rating as her total soak pool. Regardless of the type of damage, soak rolls all involve the defender rolling his soak pool. For bashing damage and chimerical lethal damage, the soak pool is Stamina + the rating of any armor he is wearing. For non-chimerical lethal damage and all aggravated damage, the soak pool is only the armor's rating. Like rolling damage, when rolling soak, the difficulty is always 6 and the roll cannot botch. Characters roll soak only after an attack hits and has done damage. At this point, the character rolls his soak pool. Each success subtracts one health level of damage. Soak rolls are reflexive rolls and do not require actions.

Example: A malicious goblin punches Roberta the Troll and inflicts three health levels of bashing damage. Before applying that damage, Roberta's player rolls a number of dice equal to her Stamina (4) and the armor rating of the biker jacket she is wearing (1), for a total of five dice. She obtains two successes. Instead of suffering three health levels of damage, Roberta only suffers one and is unimpaired as she prepares to stab the goblin with her pocket knife. If the goblin had attacked her with a physical hatchet instead, then Roberta would only have rolled one die on her soak roll, based on her biker jacket's armor rating.

Armor and Shields

Armor is worn to protect the wearer from damage and can be anything from a ratty leather jacket to shining sidhe plate armor. Regardless of how durable or elegant it is, all armor adds dice to characters' soak rolls. However, all but the lightest armor is somewhat cumbersome and inflicts penalties to the wearer's Dexterity-based dice pools. Also, armor isn't designed

to be worn all or most of the time. No one can sleep in armor, it's not comfortable to eat a meal or walk around town in it, and most armor is sufficiently obvious that people will react. Armor also takes at least several minutes to put on or take off.

Shields: Shields are large items the wielder interposes between attacks and his body. Shields increase the difficulty of attacking the wielder in close combat by +1 or +2, depending upon the size of the shield — the attacker needs to work to avoid hitting the shield rather than his target. The wielder can also use a shield to parry both close combat and ranged attacks. Rolls to use a shield to parry ranged attacks with arrows or thrown weapons are made versus difficulty 6 (rather than the normal difficulty 8 for parrying ranged attacks). In addition, if the wielder makes a successful parry roll (also versus difficulty 6), she can use the shield's armor (see Shields, p. 285) against

